

12 November 2014 request reference: 1-273972981

18 November 2014 request reference: 1-274238044

19 December 2014 request reference: 1-276355280

19 December 2014 internal review reference: 1-276484403

28 December 2014 internal review reference: 1-277884351

19 January 2015

request-146038-fa749686@whatdotheyknow.com

Graham Howell
Secretariat

information.requests@ofcom.org.uk

Freedom of Information request

Dear Mr Eckersley

Thank you for your information requests and your subsequent request for internal reviews. First let me apologise for the confusion over your different requests and reviews – this was our fault and we will seek to be as clear as possible in our responses in future.

To this end, I am responding to all your outstanding requests and internal reviews in one letter. All of the case reference numbers to which this letter refers are set out above. For the sake of clarity I have set out below the chronology of your requests and reviews and Ofcom's responses

12 November 2014 [1-273972981] - request for call signs issued in the last 10 years out of sequence.

18 November 2014 [1-274238044] – request for call signs issued in last 10 years from series' first allocations pre-WW2

16 December 2014 [1-274238044] – response from Julia Snape, citing S.12 of the Freedom of Information Act, as the relevant exemption

18 December 2014 [1-273972981] – response from Jenny Borritt, citing S.12 of the Freedom of Information Act, as the relevant exemption

19 December 2014 – request sent to Julia Snape, asking for an internal review **[1-276484403]** of the handling of the request, plus a new request for 'the same information,

but restricted to any such call sign since 2007' and the column headings on Ofcom's licensing database[1-276355280].

23 December 2014 – I emailed to clarify whether you were referring to your 12 November or 18 November request, when you asked for an internal review.

28 December 2014 – You provided some clarity on which request your internal review was for and asked for an internal review [1-277884351] of your 19 December request.

Based on the above chronology, I will conduct an internal review of the handling of your two initial requests [1-273972981 & 274238044] and provide a response to your other request [1-276355280]. I will not be conducting an internal review of your 19 December request [1-276355280], as we haven't responded yet. Once we have responded, if you are not happy with the response, you can then request the review.

1-276484403 - Internal review of 1-273972981 and 1-274238044

Following a review of your request and the information we provided, I have found that we did not answer your question regarding call signs issued out of sequence correctly. In our original response we cited Section 12 of the Freedom of Information Act, where the costs of compliance would exceed the appropriate limit. This conclusion was based on an initial assessment of our system and your request and following further inquiry it has turned out to not be accurate.

.On the subject of callsigns issued out of sequence, we have listed all call signs issued since 1st December 2006 and arranged them in order of the date of issue. Having examined this data, there does not appear to be any strict sequencing of the call-signs. This is because licensees have the ability to request their own personalised callsign upon application. This appears to be the more standard practice for customers.

With regards your request for call signs issued in the last 10 years, which were first issued before WW2; I have reviewed our response to you and I am pleased to say that the information is now attached on the first tab of Annex A

1-276355280 – Request for information

You made 3 further requests on 19 December; I will answer them 1 at a time.

- Request for call signs out of sequence, since 2007 – as I have mentioned above, there is not sequence in which call signs are issued, so Ofcom does not hold this information
- Request for call signs first issued since 2007, which were first issued pre-WW2 – it is our understanding that all call signs issued before World War 2, were in the format 'GXaa'. This information is included in the first tab of Annex A.
- Request for the column headings of information held on radio amateurs – the column headings on our database of amateur radio licenses are attached in the

second tab in Annex A. It should be noted that not all these fields are populated for each licensee.

I hope you find this response satisfactory and that it clears up any misunderstanding about your previous requests.

Yours sincerely

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'G. Howell', with a stylized flourish at the end.

Graham Howell